and a more sculptural approach. The beauty of the material still held sway with more imaginative use to the fore.

In 1988 I made my first visit to New Zealand, sharing lead demonstrating roles with Mike Darlow, which was an interesting experience. At the time New Zealand turners were working very much in a vacuum; they saw little of what was happening in the rest of the world. Tax embargoes on imported publications made their purchase prohibitive. Some of the most creative turners have since emerged from New Zealand, such as Rolly Munro and Graham Priddle.

1989

The first Nordic seminar was held this year outside Oslo, where I first met Johannes Rieber. He is the most complete turner I have encountered; I don't think there was anything he couldn't make or tell you how to do. The acclaim he deserved was probably not afforded in Norway due to a lack of receptiveness for creative turnings. He was very involved with restoration and large architectural projects, such as models of North Sea oil rigs, plus wonderful wooden toys. He did have a major exhibition of vessels at the Sonja Henie Museum many years ago that showcased some of his many talents. He was one of the most skilled and enthusiastic presenters; his party piece demonstrations were canteens and complicated tulip boxes.

1990

Back in New Zealand, this time with Dale Nish and David Ellsworth, I attended three seminar weekends on both islands. Dale and I travelled together throughout the trip, visiting two clubs mid-week and putting on slide presentations. We also visited a number of turners on our travels. The New Zealand woodturning scene had changed considerably from my previous visit, there was a far greater vibrant creativity being exhibited which continues on today.

At each seminar David, Dale and I were asked to select five prize winning exhibits from an Instant Gallery in order of merit. At the first two seminars, we did this as a team and reached a consensus agreement. At the third, David suggested we judged independently, which we did, only coming together once we had made our selections. We had each narrowed the selection down to the same seven pieces; we split up again to eliminate two and we eliminated the same two. We had consensus agreement on all five and now it was time to place them one to five independently. When we compared notes we were in agreement on the order of three, four and five; our only slight discord was on one and two. I recall this because of our very different back grounds: David has a Fine Arts degree, Dale was an Industrial Arts Professor and I was from an engineering background. When we judged, we had a shared appreciation of what was there before us. ●

Rude Osolnik – Macassar Ebony Candle Sticks

PROFILE: RAY KEY

Ray's interest in wood began when he was around four or five years old, when a German prisoner of war sparked his interest. He made Ray a three-legged stool and a leather jointed pull-along dog before he was repatriated, then sent him a turned wood chess set.

Ray first saw someone turn when he was 10 years old. Charlie Gardener used to demonstrate turning of egg cups at the Royal Show and Chelsea Flower Show, on a lathe cobbled together on a sewing machine base, which had a car gearbox to change speed.

Aged 14, Ray first turned at school, making a handle for a garden fork he had created in the metal shop. In 1958 he became an apprentice Pattern Maker for which turning was part of the job.

Buying his first lathe in 1965, Ray started a new job at Chrysler Styling Studios. The lathe kept him sane during his time there, making furniture and supplying shops across the Cotswolds with domestic useful turned wood products. By 1973, either the day job or the hobby had to go. With the full backing of his wife Liz, the day job went. That was 42 years ago; the rest is history.

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